have helped to heighten the links between terrorist outfits that are, in some way, connected with each other either through finances, training or common enemy, commiting terrorist acts assuming transnational character. International terrorism of the 20th Century made its debut in the 1970s, with the Lod airport assault in Israel on 30 May, 1972 when three terrorists killed 27 persons and injured 77 others in an operation carried out by the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP). What is remarkable is that, from the 1970s onwards, terrorism assumed a global nature, i.e. it became international.

International terrorism has often been described as *warfare without territory, waged without armies…It is warfare that is not limited territorially, sporadic battles may take place worldwide. It is warfare without neutrals, and with few or no civilian bystanders*. International terrorism covers the categories of terrorist outfits outside the country of their origin or where they are active. It is also said to comprise "those incidents of terrorism that have clear international consequences: incidents in which terrorists go abroad to strike targets, select victims or targets, because of their connections to a foreign state (diplomats, executives of foreign corporation), attack airliners on international flights, or force airlines to fly to another country".[2]

Certain key criteria have been identified with terrorism such as target, objective, motive, perpetrator, and legitimacy or legality of the act. Acts of terrorism can be identified from some of the features usually associated with it. They are:

**1. *Use of Violence:*** Acts of terror are usually associated with violence, the chief aim being to create shock in the minds of the people at large as well as the ruling elite. The aim is to send their message clearly to the target audience by using violence, organized crimes and destruction of property. To give a jolt to the national morale and blow to the national security becomes the ulterior motive of the terrorist. The Mumbai siege of 26/11 and the destruction of the heritage building of Hotel 'Taj', Oberoi Trident Hotel and Nariman House, alongside butchery of the foreign nationals as well as Indians inside the sieged buildings were nothing but use of violent methods